

The Sandwich Project — Organizational Overview

Last updated: June 10, 2026

This overview was deduced entirely from the contents of this application — its data model, workflows, grant-reporting logic, permission roles, and the operational rules baked into the code. It describes how the organization appears to run as reflected by the software that supports it. Figures marked as goals, methodology, or benchmarks are the organization's own stated assumptions, not necessarily live totals.

What they do

The Sandwich Project is a volunteer-driven nonprofit fighting hunger and food waste in **metro Atlanta** by making and distributing sandwiches to people in need. The whole organization runs on one simple, repeatable loop — but at real scale, across a distributed network of homes, groups, and partner agencies.

Who they serve

The codebase organizes recipients into focus populations, which tells you who's on their mind:

- Unhoused people (including emergency shelters)
- Youth and seniors
- Families (including single-parent and Hispanic families)
- Veterans
- LGBTQ+ and health-related programs (HIV, substance-abuse support)
- Justice-involved people (incarceration and reentry)
- Trafficking survivors
- Refugees and immigrants

They serve **through partner organizations** rather than handing food out directly — recipients in the system are agencies, and the org tracks whether each has a **signed contract** (a grant-transparency signal).

Where they operate

Squarely **Atlanta metro**, mapped to regions — North Fulton, Cobb, DeKalb, South Fulton, and Gwinnett — and dozens of named cities (Sandy Springs, Dunwoody, Buckhead, Roswell, Alpharetta, Marietta, Decatur, Clarkston, and more). The intake form even has an **"outside our typical operating areas"** flag, so geography is an active operational boundary, not just a label.

How the work actually flows

The core model has four moving parts:

1. **Hosts** — roughly 34–35 active "host homes," plus organized **group builds** (schools, churches, corporate teams, community groups) where sandwiches get made.
1. **Makers / volunteers** — individuals and groups assemble sandwiches, assembly-line style, following food-safety guidance.
1. **Drivers** — volunteers who transport finished sandwiches, sometimes needing a **refrigerated van** for large or perishable loads.
1. **Recipients** — partner agencies that receive and distribute the food to the populations above.

Collections (the count of sandwiches made) are the operational source of truth, logged on a weekly **Wednesday-Tuesday** cycle.

How events come in and get run

There's a full intake-and-follow-up machine around **group events**:

- A request comes in (often via a Google Sheet fed from the public site). An admin runs an **intake call** using a structured checklist: date, location, sandwich count, types, refrigeration, food-safety flags, corporate status, and contact info.
- The form auto-creates **"next action" to-dos** for anything needing leadership sign-off — scheduling conflicts, out-of-area events, sub-200-sandwich events, van needs, refrigeration exemptions, or young children making PB&J.
- Behind the scenes, **scheduled jobs** chase events with tiered reminders: toolkit not

sent within 24 hours, no activity in 7 days, escalations to admin, a strict daily protocol for corporate-priority events, plus 24-hour and 1-hour volunteer reminders before each event.

Who runs it (the human structure)

The role system maps cleanly onto a real org chart:

Role	Who they are
<code>super_admin</code> / <code>admin</code>	Leadership / operations — full oversight
<code>core_team</code>	Operational staff managing hosts, recipients, drivers, volunteers, events
<code>committee_member</code>	Strategic volunteers on Grants, Events, Web committees
<code>host</code>	Site hosts who log collections and access host resources
<code>driver</code>	Logistics volunteers who transport sandwiches
<code>volunteer</code>	General volunteers who sign up for events and log counts
<code>recipient</code>	Partner-agency staff with a simplified, limited view
<code>viewer</code> / <code>reviewer</code> / <code>demo_user</code>	Read-only access for auditors and grant reviewers

Named individuals in the code suggest a **small, centralized leadership**:

- **Christine and Marcy** are the decision-makers every exception routes to ("consult Christine & Marcy").
- **Katie** (katie@thesandwichproject.org) is BCC'd on *every* outgoing email — a founder/ED keeping a hand on everything.
- **Scott** maintained the historical reference spreadsheet up to August 2025.

Scale & impact (as the code frames it)

- **Lifetime: 2,000,000+ sandwiches** (they've passed a 2M goal).
 - **Annual goal: 500,000** (now runtime-configurable).
 - **Weekly target: ~10,000**, typically running **8,000–10,000/week**.
 - Reference high-water marks appear in the code (e.g., a record week of ~22,500, and a strong August 2025) — best treated as internal benchmarks rather than live totals.
 - Impact is translated into grant language: **~\$2/sandwich, \$4/meal (2 sandwiches)**, volunteer time valued at the **2024 IRS rate of \$33.49/hour**, and participant estimates of ~10 sandwiches per person.
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How it's funded and what grants pay for

They run *extremely* lean. The grant narrative frames the ask as **paid coordination capacity** — operations, group-event coordination, recipient communication, transport logistics, reporting, tech upkeep, and follow-up — **plus one additional smaller refrigerated van**. Pointedly *not* a big admin staff, office, or ingredient budget. They even note they avoided a large custom-software bill by building this platform with AI assistance and volunteer labor.

Funding priorities deduced from the data:

- Growing the **host network** beyond ~34 locations.
 - Recruiting **volunteers** to hit the 10,000/week target.
 - Covering **food, supplies, transport, and reimbursements**.
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What the codebase reveals about their values

A few things you can only learn by reading between the lines of the rules:

- **Collaboration over competition.** There's an explicit, hard rule: **never rank or compare hosts against each other.** The mission is total turnout, not leaderboards — a deliberate cultural stance.
- **Food safety is taken seriously.** Refrigeration tiers, van triggers at 500+ sandwiches, special-exemption sign-offs, and a specific "young children + PB&J" caution all require leadership approval.
- **They protect a small team from burnout.** Tiered notifications (urgent / important /

digest), batched SMS, and weekly digests all exist to *avoid alert fatigue* — a tell that the people running this are stretched thin.

- **Mobile-first, plain-language by necessity.** UX choices stress mobile experience and

unambiguous button labels because the real users are hosts, drivers, and volunteers out in the field, not desk staff.

- **An org maturing out of spreadsheets.** The Google Sheets history, the reference Excel

sheet "until August 2025," and the migration into this platform paint a picture of a grassroots effort that outgrew manual tracking and is professionalizing.

- **Corporate engagement is a growth lever.** A dedicated, aggressive corporate-event follow-up protocol and speaker coordination for big builds make corporate groups both an impact channel and a funding/relationship pipeline.

In one sentence

The Sandwich Project is a lean, volunteer-powered, leadership-centralized Atlanta nonprofit that turns a simple sandwich into a large-scale, food-safety-conscious, anti-competitive community effort — and this app is the operational backbone they built (on a shoestring) to coordinate hosts, volunteers, drivers, and partner agencies while proving their impact to funders.